

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP U.S. History Free-Response Practice Exam 12

APUSH-SAQ12-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Period 7: 1890–1945

Period: Period 7: 1890–1945

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source A: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of women’s suffrage argues that the movement succeeded because activists built a disciplined political campaign for constitutional change. According to this interpretation, suffragists used lobbying, state referendums, national organizations, parades, and wartime arguments about democracy to pressure lawmakers.

Source B: Original secondary interpretation written for this practice exam, not an actual quotation.

A historian of gender and social movements argues that suffrage activism also grew from broader challenges to women’s public roles. According to this interpretation, suffrage was connected to labor activism, settlement work, temperance, education, Black women’s club organizing, and debates over whether women’s moral authority should shape public policy.

- (a) Describe one major difference between the two interpretations of women’s suffrage activism.
- (b) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source A.
- (c) Explain one piece of historical evidence that supports the argument in Source B.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Describes a valid difference, such as Source A emphasizing formal political strategy and constitutional change, while Source B emphasizes broader social reform, gender roles, club work, labor activism, and moral authority.
- (b) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source A, such as the National American Woman Suffrage Association, Congressional Union/National Woman’s Party, suffrage parades, lobbying Congress, state suffrage campaigns, picketing the White House, World War I democracy arguments, or the Nineteenth Amendment.
- (c) 1 point: Explains relevant evidence supporting Source B, such as women’s clubs, settlement houses, labor activism, temperance networks, Black women’s organizations, education reform, maternalist reform, or women’s participation in Progressive Era public life.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should recognize that suffrage was both a constitutional campaign and part of a wider transformation in women’s public activism. It should avoid treating the Nineteenth Amendment as an isolated event and should explain how reform networks, race, class, labor, and gender expectations shaped the movement.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ12-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Period 2: 1607–1754

Period: Period 2: 1607–1754

Theme: WXT — Work, Exchange, and Technology

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Original simulated source based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

An indentured servant writing to a cousin in Germany from Pennsylvania, 1736.

“I agreed to years of service because passage across the ocean could not be paid in coin. The master says my time belongs to him, but I count the months and keep hope for land or wages after freedom. Some servants run away, and some die before their term is finished. Yet others say that a poor person in Europe has fewer chances than a servant who survives these years in America.”

- (a) Identify one historical development that shaped the situation described in the source.
- (b) Explain how the author’s point of view likely influenced the description of indentured servitude.
- (c) Explain one way the source reflects broader labor or migration patterns in colonial British North America.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a relevant development, such as European migration to the British colonies, indentured servitude, labor scarcity in colonial economies, transatlantic passage costs, population growth in Pennsylvania, or colonial demand for agricultural and craft labor.
- (b) 1 point: Explains that the author’s perspective as an indentured servant shaped the description by emphasizing limited choice, debt for passage, loss of control over labor, hope for eventual independence, risk of death, and comparison with poverty in Europe.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader pattern, such as the use of indentured servants to meet labor demands, the attraction of land or wages in the colonies, voluntary and coerced migration across the Atlantic, differences between servitude and slavery, or the transition in some regions toward other labor systems.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should explain indentured servitude as part of transatlantic migration and colonial labor demand. It should avoid treating all colonial labor as the same and should distinguish the servant’s limited-term contract from both free labor and hereditary racial slavery.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-SAQ12-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Period 9: 1980–Present

Period: Period 9: 1980–Present

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Described policy-and-incarceration chart created for this practice exam.

The chart is titled “Drug Policy, Policing, and Incarceration in the United States, 1980–2000.”

Indicator | 1980 | 1990 | 2000

Federal and state attention to drug crime | rising | very high | still high

Mandatory minimum sentencing policies | limited | expanded | widespread in many jurisdictions

Prison population | increasing | rising sharply | much higher than in 1980

Public debate over racial disparities | limited national attention | growing concern | significant criticism by activists and scholars

Common policy language | “law and order” | “war on drugs” | “public safety,” “sentencing reform,” and “community impact”

The chart notes that figures are approximate and are intended to show broad policy and social trends.

- (a) Describe one change in criminal justice policy or incarceration reflected in the chart.
- (b) Explain one historical factor that contributed to the change described in part (a).
- (c) Explain one social or political consequence of the changes reflected in the chart.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Describes a valid change, such as increased attention to drug crime, expansion of mandatory minimum sentencing, sharp growth in prison populations, or growing debate over racial disparities in criminal justice.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant factor, such as law-and-order politics, the War on Drugs, concerns about crack cocaine, Anti-Drug Abuse Acts, federal funding for policing, media coverage of crime, urban economic distress, or bipartisan support for tougher sentencing.

(c) 1 point: Explains a relevant consequence, such as mass incarceration, racial disparities in imprisonment, increased prison spending, community disruption, political mobilization for sentencing reform, debates over policing, or criticism from civil rights and legal advocacy groups.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should connect criminal justice policy to politics, public fear, federal and state lawmaking, and social consequences. It should avoid describing incarceration growth as automatic and should explain how policy choices shaped communities and debates over justice.

Expected Points:

3

APUSH-DBQ12-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Period 8: 1945–1980

Period: Period 8: 1945–1980

Theme: WOR — America in the World

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which the Vietnam War changed Americans' relationship with the federal government and political authority from 1964 to 1975.

Document 1

Author/Origin: Summary of congressional debate over the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, Washington, D.C., 1964.

Source Type: Legislative debate summary.

Supporters argued that the president needed authority to respond quickly to attacks on U.S. forces and prevent communist expansion in Southeast Asia. A small number of critics warned that broad authorization could give the executive branch too much power without a formal declaration of war. Most lawmakers approved the resolution with limited public debate.

Sourcing Cues: The summary reflects Cold War assumptions, executive authority, and congressional willingness to authorize military action quickly.

Document 2

Author/Origin: Described television news scene created for this practice exam, United States, 1967.

Source Type: Described visual source.

The scene shows a family sitting in a living room watching evening news footage of helicopters, wounded soldiers, burning villages, and antiwar demonstrators. A graphic on the television screen lists weekly casualty numbers. A newspaper on the coffee table carries the headline "Officials Predict Progress."

Sourcing Cues: The visual emphasizes the role of television, casualty reporting, and contrasting official optimism with images of war.

Document 3

Author/Origin: Original simulated leaflet from a student antiwar organization, California, 1968; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Protest leaflet excerpt.

"We are told that bombing villages protects freedom. We are told that questioning the war helps the enemy. But young men are drafted to fight in a war that officials explain with slogans and secrecy. A democratic nation must not demand obedience before it offers truth."

Sourcing Cues: The leaflet reflects student activism, draft opposition, distrust of official explanations, and moral criticism of the war.

Document 4

Author/Origin: Draft lottery and service data table created for this practice exam, United States, 1969–1972.

Source Type: Data table.

The table is titled "Selected Patterns in Vietnam-Era Military Service."

Group or condition | Common pattern

Men with low draft lottery numbers | higher likelihood of being called for service

College students before policy changes | more likely to receive deferments

Working-class men | often had fewer paths to deferment

African American and Latino communities | frequently criticized unequal burdens of service

Returning veterans | faced divided public attitudes and uneven support

A note beneath the table states: "Military service patterns were shaped by draft rules, education, class, race, local draft boards, and policy changes."

Sourcing Cues: The table highlights how the draft shaped perceptions of fairness, citizenship, and political legitimacy.

Document 5

Author/Origin: Original simulated letter from a Vietnam veteran to a local newspaper, Ohio, 1971; based on historical context, not an actual quotation.

Source Type: Newspaper letter excerpt.

“I served because my country called, but I came home asking what our leaders knew and when they knew it. Men in my unit did what they were ordered to do; the question is whether the orders rested on truth. Those who protest us are wrong if they blame every soldier, but right if they ask whether citizens were misled.”

Sourcing Cues: The letter reflects a veteran’s distinction between military service, government credibility, and public criticism of war policy.

Document 6

Author/Origin: Public opinion chart created for this practice exam, United States, 1965–1974.

Source Type: Data chart.

The chart is titled “Selected Trends in Public Trust and Vietnam War Opinion.”

Year | Common public pattern

1965 | majority support for escalation; relatively high trust in federal leadership

1968 | support divided after Tet Offensive; growing credibility concerns

1971 | increased skepticism after publication of secret government documents

1973 | support for limiting presidential war powers increased

1974 | public trust remained weakened after Vietnam and Watergate-era revelations

A note states: “The chart summarizes broad trends rather than precise polling percentages.”

Sourcing Cues: The chart connects war opinion, government credibility, and broader distrust of political leadership.

Document 7

Author/Origin: Summary of congressional debate over war powers legislation, Washington, D.C., 1973.

Source Type: Government policy summary.

Supporters argued that Congress needed to reclaim a constitutional role in decisions about military action after years of escalation in Vietnam. Critics warned that limiting presidential flexibility could endanger national security in a fast-moving world. The debate reflected broader concerns about executive power, secrecy, and public accountability.

Sourcing Cues: The summary reflects how Vietnam contributed to institutional debates over presidential authority and congressional oversight.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible claim evaluating the extent to which the Vietnam War changed Americans’ relationship with the federal government and political authority from 1964 to 1975. The thesis must make an argument, such as that Vietnam significantly weakened trust in federal leadership, expanded protest, intensified debates over draft fairness and executive power, and encouraged demands for greater congressional oversight.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader relevant context, such as Cold War containment, fear of communism in Asia, the Korean War, postwar faith in federal institutions, civil rights and student activism, television news, the draft, or rising skepticism toward authority in the 1960s and 1970s.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point for accurately using content from at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points for using content from at least six documents

to support a coherent argument about executive authority, television coverage, student protest, draft inequality, veterans' criticism, public trust, or congressional war powers.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point for using at least one specific, relevant piece of outside evidence not found in the documents, such as Tet Offensive, Pentagon Papers, My Lai, Students for a Democratic Society, draft-card burning, Kent State, Cambodia invasion, Vietnamization, Silent Majority, 26th Amendment, War Powers Act, or Watergate.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. For example, a student might analyze the Gulf of Tonkin debate's Cold War assumptions, television's effect on public perception, the student leaflet's antiwar purpose, the draft table's class and racial implications, the veteran letter's credibility concerns, or war powers debate as an institutional response to executive secrecy.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced argument, such as explaining that many Americans continued to support soldiers or anti-communist goals while distrusting policymakers; distinguishing criticism of the war from rejection of military service; connecting Vietnam to Watergate-era distrust; or showing how protest, media, Congress, courts, veterans, and ordinary families experienced authority differently.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ would likely argue that the Vietnam War substantially changed Americans' relationship with government by weakening trust, increasing protest, raising questions about the draft, and producing institutional challenges to presidential war-making. Students should not treat public opinion as uniform. Useful document groupings include executive power, media and credibility, student protest, draft fairness, veterans' perspectives, public trust, and congressional oversight. Relevant outside evidence could include Tet, the Pentagon Papers, My Lai, Kent State, Cambodia, SDS, Vietnamization, the Silent Majority, the 26th Amendment, the War Powers Act, or Watergate.

Expected Points:

7

APUSH-LEQ12-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Period 4: 1800–1848

Period: Cross-Period / Thematic

Theme: PCE — Politics and Power

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From the early republic through the New Deal era, the Supreme Court shaped debates over federal power, state authority, property rights, economic regulation, civil rights, and constitutional interpretation. Students may choose to focus on cases and controversies involving judicial review, commerce, banking, slavery, Reconstruction amendments, segregation, labor regulation, or New Deal legislation.

Evaluate the extent to which the Supreme Court changed the relationship among the federal government, the states, and individual rights from 1803 to 1937.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point for a historically defensible thesis that evaluates the extent to which the Supreme Court changed the relationship among the federal government, the

states, and individual rights from 1803 to 1937. The thesis must make an argument about continuity, change, or both.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing broader context relevant to constitutional development, such as debates over federalism, the early republic, market expansion, slavery and sectional conflict, Reconstruction, industrial capitalism, Progressive reform, or the Great Depression and New Deal.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point for identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as *Marbury v. Madison*, *McCulloch v. Maryland*, *Gibbons v. Ogden*, *Dred Scott v. Sandford*, *Slaughter-House Cases*, *Civil Rights Cases*, *Plessy v. Ferguson*, *Lochner v. New York*, *Muller v. Oregon*, *Hammer v. Dagenhart*, *Schechter Poultry Corp. v. United States*, or *West Coast Hotel v. Parrish*. Earns 2 points for using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about constitutional change and continuity.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining continuity and change over time, such as showing how the Court expanded judicial review and sometimes strengthened federal authority while also limiting civil rights protections, protecting property and contract rights, or later permitting broader economic regulation during the New Deal era.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by developing a nuanced argument, such as explaining that the Court did not consistently favor either federal or state power; distinguishing economic rights from civil rights; showing how constitutional interpretation changed in response to political and economic crises; or comparing the Court's role in the early republic, Reconstruction, the Gilded Age, Progressive Era, and New Deal.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should make a constitutional argument over time rather than simply list court cases. It might argue that the Supreme Court strengthened its own authority and sometimes expanded federal power, but also limited civil rights protections after Reconstruction and protected property rights against regulation before shifting during the New Deal era. Strong responses should connect specific cases to broader developments such as federalism, slavery, industrialization, segregation, labor regulation, and economic crisis.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APUSH-FRQ12

· APUSH-SAQ12-001: Unit 7; Period 7: 1890–1945; perspectives include modern secondary historians of women's suffrage as disciplined constitutional-political campaigning and as broader gender/social reform activism; source type is paired secondary text interpretations; source viewpoints contrast lobbying, state referendums, national organizations, parades, wartime democracy arguments, and constitutional amendment strategy with labor activism, settlement work, temperance, education, Black women's club organizing, and women's moral authority in public policy; historical development is women's suffrage activism and the Nineteenth Amendment; reasoning path is comparison; misconception targeted is treating women's suffrage as an isolated amendment campaign rather than a movement shaped by formal politics, social reform, race, class, labor, and gender expectations.

· APUSH-SAQ12-002: Unit 2; Period 2: 1607–1754; perspective is German indentured servant in colonial Pennsylvania in 1736; source type is original simulated primary letter; source viewpoint emphasizes transatlantic passage costs, contractual labor, limited autonomy, risk of death or flight, hope for land/wages, and comparison between European poverty and colonial opportunity; historical development is indentured servitude, European migration, labor scarcity, and colonial

labor systems in British North America; reasoning path is POV/purpose/audience connected to migration, labor contracts, debt, opportunity, and coercion; misconception targeted is treating all colonial labor systems as either fully free labor or hereditary racial slavery without recognizing indentured servitude's intermediate and time-bound form.

· APUSH-SAQ12-003: Unit 9; Period 9: 1980–Present; perspectives include policymakers, law enforcement, people convicted under drug laws, communities affected by incarceration, civil rights advocates, legal scholars, and sentencing reformers; non-text source type is plain-text policy-and-incarceration chart; visual/data/map pattern is rising attention to drug crime, mandatory minimum expansion, prison population increase, debate over racial disparities, and changing policy language from “law and order” to “war on drugs” and sentencing reform; historical development is War on Drugs, mandatory minimum sentencing, mass incarceration, and racial disparities in criminal justice from 1980 to 2000; reasoning path is causation linking law-and-order politics, drug policy, sentencing law, policing, public fear, and social consequences; misconception targeted is treating incarceration growth as automatic crime response rather than as a result of policy choices and political debates.

· APUSH-DBQ12-001: Unit 8; Period 8: 1945–1980; DBQ topic is the Vietnam War changing Americans' relationship with the federal government and political authority from 1964 to 1975; document types include Gulf of Tonkin legislative debate summary, described television news scene, student antiwar leaflet, draft lottery/service data table, Vietnam veteran newspaper letter, public trust and war opinion data chart, and congressional war powers debate summary; document perspectives include Cold War lawmakers, television viewers, student protesters, draftees, working-class men, African American and Latino communities, Vietnam veterans, ordinary families, public opinion observers, and congressional critics of executive power; main argument paths include executive authority, Cold War containment assumptions, television and credibility, antiwar protest, draft fairness, veteran criticism, public trust decline, secrecy, congressional oversight, and war powers reform; outside evidence possibilities include Tet Offensive, Pentagon Papers, My Lai, Students for a Democratic Society, draft-card burning, Kent State, Cambodia invasion, Vietnamization, Silent Majority, 26th Amendment, War Powers Act, and Watergate; sourcing opportunities include Gulf of Tonkin Cold War assumptions, visual television influence, student leaflet's protest purpose, draft table's class/race implications, veteran credibility critique, opinion chart's trust pattern, and congressional war powers debate as institutional reaction; visual/data/map types include described television news scene, draft/service data table, and public trust/war opinion data chart.

· APUSH-LEQ12-001: Units 4–7; Periods 4–7 / Cross-Period; LEQ topic is the Supreme Court changing the relationship among federal government, states, and individual rights from 1803 to 1937; historical reasoning process is continuity and change over time; evidence categories include *Marbury v. Madison*, *McCulloch v. Maryland*, *Gibbons v. Ogden*, *Dred Scott v. Sandford*, *Slaughter-House Cases*, *Civil Rights Cases*, *Plessy v. Ferguson*, *Lochner v. New York*, *Muller v. Oregon*, *Hammer v. Dagenhart*, *Schechter Poultry Corp. v. United States*, and *West Coast Hotel v. Parrish*; complexity path is distinguishing federal power, state authority, economic rights, civil rights, property rights, judicial review, and constitutional interpretation across the early republic, Reconstruction, industrial era, Progressive Era, and New Deal; misconception targeted is treating the Supreme Court as consistently pro-federal or pro-states' rights rather than as an institution whose interpretation shifted across issues and periods.